

Speaking

What Were You Doing?

Pairs · 8-10 min

In pairs, take turns asking and answering what you were doing at three different times yesterday (e.g. 8am, 1pm, 7pm), using the past progressive.

Useful language: What were you doing at...?, I was... / I wasn't..., While I was..., I also..., Really? I was doing something similar.

1. Choose three times from yesterday to talk about.
2. Ask your partner what they were doing at each time.
3. Answer your partner's questions using the past progressive.
4. Find one thing you were both doing at a similar time and share it with the class.

City Transport Debate

Groups of 3-4 · 10-12 min

In small groups, discuss the pros and cons of at least three types of transportation (bus, metro, bike, car, walking) and agree on the best option for students commuting to school.

Useful language: One advantage of... is..., On the other hand, a disadvantage is..., In my opinion, the best option is... because..., Don't you think... would be more convenient?

1. In your group, list the transportation options available in your city.
2. Discuss one advantage and one disadvantage of each option.
3. Use question tags to check your group members' opinions, e.g. 'The bus is cheaper, isn't it?'
4. Agree on the best option for students and prepare to explain your choice to the class.

Writing

An Afternoon in the Neighbourhood

100-130 words

Write a short narrative about an afternoon when something interesting happened at a neighbourhood attraction (cafe, cinema, gym or sports club). Use both the past progressive and the simple past.

Plan:

1. Decide where the story takes place and who is involved.
2. Note what was happening in the background (past progressive).
3. Decide what event interrupted or changed the situation (simple past).
4. Think of a short, natural ending.

Checklist:

- ☐ I used the past progressive for background actions.
- ☐ I used the simple past for completed/interrupting actions.
- ☐ I used at least three vocabulary words from this theme.
- ☐ My story is within the word limit.

Comparing Two Ways to Travel

120-150 words

Write a paragraph comparing two types of transportation you could use in your city, explaining the advantages and disadvantages of each and giving your own opinion.

Plan:

1. Choose two types of transportation to compare.
2. List one advantage and one disadvantage for each.
3. Add a sentence with a question tag to invite the reader's agreement.
4. Write a concluding sentence giving your personal preference.

Checklist:

- ☐ I compared two transportation types clearly.
- ☐ I included at least one question tag.
- ☐ I gave my own opinion with a reason.
- ☐ I used vocabulary from this theme correctly.